

FEDERAL MARITIME COMMISSION
Office of Administrative Law Judges

AMAN KAUSHIK, *Complainant*

v.

SFL WORLDWIDE LLC, *Respondent*.

DOCKET NO. 26-10

Served: July 24, 2026

ORDER OF: Alex M. CHINTELLA, *Administrative Law Judge*.

ORDER DENYING WITHOUT PREJUDICE COMPLAINANT’S MOTION FOR EXTENSION OF TIME

On July 14, 2026, Complainant file a motion for extension of time to make initial disclosures, file a joint status report, and participate in the CADRS preliminary conference. Dkt. 5. As grounds for the motion, Complainant states that he is proceeding *pro se* and is unable to afford counsel, is recovering from a hand fracture that makes is difficult to type, is a non-citizen living in India, is involved in five other legal proceedings, and is seeking employment. Mot. for Extension [Dkt. 5] 2-5.

As stated in the Initial Order, the Commission’s rules regarding motions require, among other things, that the parties confer prior to filing non-dispositive motions:

(a) Duty to confer. Before filing a non-dispositive motion as defined in § 502.69(g) of [Subpart E], the parties must attempt to discuss the anticipated motion with each other in a good faith effort to determine whether there is any opposition to the relief sought and, if there is opposition, to narrow the areas of disagreement. The moving party must state within the body of the motion what attempt was made or that the discussion occurred and whether the motion is opposed.

46 C.F.R. § 502.71(a). Complainant’s motion to extend does not indicate that he conferred with Respondent’s counsel. Since the motion does not comply with Commission Rule 71, it is DENIED. Complainant may refile the motion after complying with the rule.

I encourage Complainant to review the Initial Order and the resources available on the Commission’s website regarding the rules of procedure applicable to this proceeding: <https://www.fmc.gov/complaints-and-assistance/resources-for-attorneys-and-litigants/>. These rules will not be waived on the grounds that a party is proceeding *pro se* or is unfamiliar with practice before the Commission. See *Rana v. Franklin*, Docket No. 19-03, 2022 WL 1744905 *6-7 (FMC May 25, 2022) (affirming ALJ’s discovery sanctions on *pro se* party who refused to comply with Commission’s discovery rules); see also *Maralan, et al. – Possible Violations of*

Sections 8(a)(1), 10(b)(1), 19(a) and 23(a) of the Shipping Act of 1984, Docket No. 98-19, 1999 WL 377911 *3 (ALJ March 9, 1999) (noting that, while *pro se* pleadings are held to less stringent standards, courts have held that *pro se* litigants must follow the same rules that govern represented litigants).

Complainant's motion for extension of time [Dkt. 5] is hereby **DENIED WITHOUT PREJUDICE**.

**ALEX
CHINTELLA** Digitally signed by
ALEX CHINTELLA
Date: 2026.07.24
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Alex M. Chintella
Administrative Law Judge